

Unit 5 assessment

Unit summary

A teacher's week is dominated by work that is invisible from outside and therefore elastic: marking, returns, cover, parent contact, assigned duties. It lands on whoever absorbs it, so workload falls hardest on the most conscientious, and preparation is dropped first because it alone has no external deadline.

Stress is episodic and resolves. Burnout is what chronic unresolved demand produces, and it has three dimensions: exhaustion, cynicism or distancing, and a reduced sense of accomplishment. It comes from the relationship between demands and resources, so adding a resource is a lever when removing a demand is not. Cynicism is the dimension that looks like realism. Missing resources are physical, human, instructional and structural, and the last two are the most underestimated. Multilingual classrooms impose a cognitive load easily misread as low ability, and excluding the home language removes the pupil's best resource. Multi-grade teaching is a distinct, widely required and barely taught skill.

Accountability has grown and the case for it is sound; what it does not supply is anything that makes the measured work easier. Without autonomy it produces narrowing, effort shifted to the record of the work, and managed exposure. Many parties make demands, and for nearly all of them what they want and what they measure differ. The demands conflict, no party sees the whole job, and the teacher is the only one who does. Teaching's status is uneven rather than low; status shapes who enters, practice shapes the recognition a community extends.

Pressure to use technology rarely originates in a question about learning. Judge a use by what it adds, what it costs, and what it replaces that was working. Obligations do not weaken because the medium changed.

A teacher's situation divides into what they control, what they can influence, and what they do not. Most frustration comes from effort spent in the third region, and the characteristic failure is using an accurate judgement about

conditions to justify inaction where there is room. Resilience offered as the whole answer relocates a system's failure into a person's character.

Summative assessment

Multiple-choice questions (MCQs)

1. The part of a teacher's workload that expands under pressure is characteristically: *(Understand)*
 - a) timetabled teaching
 - b) work specified in the service rules
 - c) examination duties
 - d) the work that is invisible from outside the school
2. The dimension of burnout that most often looks like competence to a colleague is: *(Understand)*
 - a) reduced sense of accomplishment
 - b) exhaustion
 - c) cynicism or distancing
 - d) time pressure
3. A pupil sends a teacher a private message on a messaging app. The professional default is to: *(Apply)*
 - a) reply on a channel a parent or colleague can see, rather than privately
 - b) reply privately but keep the exchange brief
 - c) not reply at all, in any form
 - d) reply privately and delete the thread afterwards
4. Excluding a pupil's home language from the classroom is a mistake mainly because it: *(Apply)*
 - a) breaks a school rule
 - b) removes the pupil's best resource for understanding a difficult idea

- c) slows the syllabus
 - d) is unpopular with parents
5. An accountability mechanism that measures but supplies nothing will typically: *(Understand)*
- a) reduce workload
 - b) improve teaching directly
 - c) be ignored entirely
 - d) change behaviour without improving teaching
6. For most parties making demands on a teacher, what they want and what they measure: *(Remember)*
- a) are the same thing
 - b) differ, and the gap is where much of the difficulty lives
 - c) are both set by the district
 - d) are both invisible to the teacher
7. Teaching's occupational status is best described as: *(Understand)*
- a) uneven across markers, so that pay, autonomy and recognition do not move together
 - b) determined entirely by pay
 - c) equal to medicine and law
 - d) uniformly low across every marker
8. The question most often missed when judging a classroom use of technology is: *(Apply)*
- a) what does it cost in money
 - b) what does it add
 - c) what does it replace that was already working
 - d) who supplied it
9. A teacher who is accurate that class size cannot be changed, and uses that to justify changing nothing at all, has: *(Apply)*
- a) acted as a change agent

- b) correctly identified what is outside their control
- c) failed at resilience
- d) used a true judgement about one region to excuse inaction in another

10. Offering resilience as the whole answer to structural conditions chiefly:
(*Understand*)

- a) relocates a system's failure into an individual's character
- b) applies only to multi-grade classrooms
- c) contradicts the evidence on burnout dimensions
- d) is good advice for new teachers

Restricted-response questions (RRQs)

1. Explain why workload falls hardest on the most conscientious teachers under the conditions described. (*Understand*)
2. Distinguish stress from burnout, name burnout's three dimensions, and state where each of this unit's two burnout sources was conducted.
(*Understand*)
3. Name the four categories of missing resource and explain why the instructional and structural ones are the most underestimated. (*Analyze*)
4. Give two predictable effects of accountability arriving without autonomy or resources. (*Understand*)
5. For any three stakeholders, state what that party wants and what that party actually measures. (*Apply*)
6. Distinguish occupational status from public recognition, and explain what follows for a teacher who believes nothing they do affects how teaching is regarded. (*Analyze*)
7. State the three questions to ask of any proposed classroom use of technology, and explain why the third is the hardest to answer honestly.
(*Understand*)

8. Give two problems with a class messaging group that are social rather than technical. (*Understand*)
9. Name the three regions into which a teacher's situation divides, with two examples in each. (*Remember*)
10. Explain why "decide in advance what would show it worked" is the station most often skipped, and what goes wrong when it is. (*Analyze*)

Extended-response questions (ERQs)

1. Analyse Miss Shahnaz's Tuesday using the demands-and-resources idea. Identify which demands could realistically be removed and which could not, propose the two interventions most likely to help, and state which parts of your analysis rest on the cited research and which are reasoned from the described conditions. (*Analyze*)
2. Mr Rafiq receives four demands in one week from his head, a parent, the district and a newspaper. Rank them, state the criterion your ranking rests on, and address the objection that deprioritising the head is unrealistic for someone whose confirmation depends on that head's report. (*Evaluate*)
3. Ms Sundas is given forty tablets she cannot usefully deploy and a request for photographs of them in use. Decide what she should do, work at least two uses through the three questions, and address the objection that refusing a donated resource is ungrateful. (*Evaluate*)
4. Take one challenge described in this unit, place it in the three regions, and design a response that is within a teacher's control. State what your change does not fix, and answer the charge that individual adaptation lets the system off the hook. (*Create*)
5. **Integrative.** A teacher in a rural government school has a multi-grade Class 4 and 5 of fifty-one pupils across three home languages, no cover arrangement, a district requiring monthly returns, and a head asking for better results. She has begun telling trainees not to bother with group work. Analyse her situation across conditions, demands and response: identify what is happening to her, distinguish the structural from the personal, and say what could realistically change and who would have to act. (*Evaluate*)

Answers and marking guidance

MCQ answer key

1. **d** - the invisible work is elastic, so it absorbs pressure; the timetable does not move.
2. **c** - a teacher who has stopped investing is no longer visibly distressed, which reads as competence or realism.
3. **a** - the obligations from Unit 2 do not change because the medium changed, and the power imbalance that makes a private conversation a matter of care does not weaken on a phone. A visible channel protects the pupil first and the teacher second. Refusing to reply at all abandons a pupil who may need the contact; deleting the thread destroys the record that protects both parties.
4. **b** - the home language is the pupil's working resource for a difficult idea, not an obstacle.
5. **d** - measurement changes behaviour; without supplied resources the behaviour change is not an improvement in teaching.
6. **b** - the want-measure gap is the topic's central analytical point.
7. **a** - uneven; teaching scores differently on pay, entry selectivity, autonomy and recognition.
8. **c** - the replacement question is the one nobody asks, and the one that catches a video replacing a teacher who can notice confusion.
9. **d** - the judgement about class size is correct and is doing work it cannot do.
10. **a** - it converts an institutional failure into a personal deficiency.

RRQ model answers and mark schemes

1. (4 marks) The elastic work is invisible and unallocated (1); it lands on whoever absorbs it (1); conscientious teachers absorb more (1); so the burden correlates with commitment rather than with formal duty (1).

2. (6 marks) Stress is episodic and resolves (1); burnout follows chronic unresolved demand (1); exhaustion, cynicism or distancing, reduced accomplishment (3); names Maslach and Leiter as human-service occupations generally and Skaalvik and Skaalvik as 262 Norwegian high-school teachers (1).

3. (5 marks) Physical, human, instructional, structural (2); instructional and structural absences are invisible and undiscussed (1); they convert solvable problems into permanent ones (1); an example such as having nobody to ask about a pupil who cannot decode (1).

4. (4 marks) Two of: what is measured becomes what is done; effort moves from the work to the record of the work; teachers manage exposure rather than improving practice. Two marks per effect, one for naming and one for the mechanism.

5. (6 marks) Two marks per stakeholder: what they want and what they measure, correctly distinguished.

6. (5 marks) Status is the occupation's structural standing, recognition is what a community extends (2); structural status is not shiftable by one teacher (1); recognition is affected by the teachers people actually meet (1); so the belief is false of recognition even where true of status (1).

7. (5 marks) What does it add, what does it cost, what does it replace that was working (3); the third is hardest because it requires admitting that the existing practice had value (1); and because nobody proposing the technology is asking it (1).

8. (4 marks) Two of: pupils without a phone are excluded from what is announced; availability expectations expand without decision; messages are permanent and forwardable. Two marks each.

9. (9 marks) Three marks per region: name (1) and two apt examples (2).

10. (4 marks) It is skipped because it is not required to act (1); and because deciding afterwards is easier (1); what goes wrong is that a measure chosen after the fact confirms whatever was hoped (1); so the result cannot surprise you and no learning occurs (1).

ERQ rubrics

Each ERQ is marked out of 20 across four criteria. A response not reaching "Adequate" on the analysis, evaluation or creation criterion cannot exceed 10 overall.

ERQ 1 - Miss Shahnaz's Tuesday

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Use of the model	Demands and resources conflated	Separated accurately	Applied to the specific Tuesday, not to teaching in general
Realism about constraints	Treats all demands as removable	Distinguishes removable from fixed	Distinguishes what a teacher, head and district can each change
Defence of interventions (Analyze)	Proposals asserted	Proposals defended	Answers the objection that they depend on others acting, and says what remains if nobody does
Evidence honesty	Cites studies without scope	Notes scope	States which claims are research-backed and which are reasoned

ERQ 2 - Four demands, one week

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Analysis of demands	Lists them	Separates want from measure	Does so for every demand, including the newspaper

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Non-claims identified	Ranks all four	Questions one	Argues which are not claims on him at all, and why
Justified ranking (Evaluate)	Order asserted	Order with reasons	States and defends the criterion the order rests on
Career realism (Analyze)	Ignores consequence	Notes it	Engages with the cost of deprioritising the head and still reaches a position

ERQ 3 - The forty tablets

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Use of the three questions	One applied	All three applied to one use	All three applied to at least two uses, including replacement
The photograph request	Treated as administrative	Noticed as an issue	Handled as a pupil-image obligation with a specific response
Answering the objection (Evaluate)	Dismisses donor relations	Acknowledges them	Proposes something defensible that does not require pretending the tablets work

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Realism	Recommends the impossible	Workable	Something Ms Sundas could carry out next week

ERQ 4 - Place it and change it

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Placement	Regions confused	Placed correctly	Splits a challenge that falls across regions
Design of the response (Create)	Vague intention	A specific change	Small enough to make without permission, with the evidence decided in advance
Honesty about limits	Overclaims	States what is not fixed	States it precisely and early
Systemic objection (Analyze)	Ignored	Acknowledged	Engaged seriously, without abandoning either individual action or structural critique

ERQ 5 - Integrative: the rural multi-grade teacher

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Breadth	Draws on one topic	Draws on two or three	Uses conditions, demands and response together

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Diagnosis	Describes her situation	Names what is happening to her	Distinguishes the two readings of the group-work remark - burnout cynicism (Topic 5.1) or an accurate third-region judgement being used to excuse first-region inaction (Topic 5.4) - and argues from the text which the evidence supports
Structural and personal separated (Evaluate)	Blurred	Separated	Separated precisely, with what each actor could change named
Realism of the response	Requires resources she lacks	Workable in part	Every proposal is available to a named person in her actual situation

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

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